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Labor Day sees workers struggling to keep rights

Federal firings, attacks on collective bargaining, AI threats plague movement

By Katie Johnston
GLOBE STAFF

Just a few years ago, employees had the upper hand — insisting on working remotely and job-hopping with abandon. But today, American workers are getting pummeled from almost every direction.

Thousands of federal employees have been fired. Safety regulations are being abandoned, minimum wage guarantees for millions are on the chopping block, and union rights have been scrapped, including an executive order issued Thursday to take away collective bargaining from workers at NASA and the National Weather Service, among other agencies.

Immigrants who provide essential services are being detained and deported. Artificial intelligence is threatening entry-level positions. And as worries about tariffs and federal funding cuts and a recession grow, companies are scaling back.

Unions and worker advocates have been fighting, and winning a few battles in court, but the upheaval is relentless. On Monday, the Greater Boston Labor Council is holding its first Labor Day parade as part of a national “Workers Over Billionaires” event, with more than 1,000 rallies and protests planned across the country.

WORKERS' RIGHTS, Page A10

Harvard on edge as wary students return

Many on campus want to defy Trump demands, others fear loss of grants

By Aidan Ryan, Anjali Huynh, and Tal Kopan
GLOBE STAFF

For months, Harvard University and the Trump administration have been negotiating a settlement that could resolve federal investigations into the university and its culture and restore billions of

INSIDE
THE WAR ON
HARVARD

dollars in canceled research funding. And at least in Cambridge, many had hoped that a resolution could come before students returned to campus for the fall semester.

But with classes set to begin Tuesday, no agreement has materialized. And even as Harvard students, faculty, and alums anxiously await news of a deal, the resumption of normal campus life for the fall could complicate negotiations, at least for Harvard's administration.

When campus was quiet for the summer, Harvard made changes — some in line with White House demands — that many students and faculty oppose. Now those students and faculty are back, and the pressure to make a wide-ranging deal that its campus can accept, or to keep fighting an administration many loathe, will likely only grow.

HARVARD, Page A10

Judge blocks children's removal

Dozens of minors were on planes set for Guatemala before action halted

By Miriam Jordan and Aishvarya Kavi
NEW YORK TIMES

With children already loaded onto planes, a federal judge Sunday temporarily blocked the Trump administration from deporting dozens of Guatemalan minors and demanded assurances that they would remain in shelters until a more permanent ruling.

The order brought to a close, for now, another last-minute flurry of court action in the administration's mass deportation drive. Lawyers for the children said that they would face peril if they were sent to Guatemala and that doing so would deny them due process. They also argued that the government had ignored special protections for minors who cross the border alone.

In the early hours Sunday, Judge Sparkle Sooknanan of the US District Court for the District of Columbia issued a temporary restraining order forbidding the administration from deporting the children after the National Immigration Law Center filed an emergency request.

Sooknanan's order was intended to be in place until an emergency hearing could be held in the afternoon. But there was initial confusion among lawyers whether the order applied to a limited number of children.

Dozens of children were then removed by immigration authorities from shelters overnight and boarded onto chartered planes. After lawyers for the children notified the judge, the emergency hearing was moved up to midday, and with planes awaiting takeoff in Texas, the judge clarified her order to apply to all Guatemalan children in the custody of the federal Office of Refugee Resettlement for the next 14 days while the case is pending. She directed the government to take the

DEPORTATION ORDER, Page A6

‘If I go back to Afghanistan, I will be killed.’

ZIA, who holds a Special Immigrant Visa, granted for his work as an interpreter for the US military



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Zia's wife and five children posed for a portrait in their home in Connecticut. Zia is in custody in an Immigration and Customs Enforcement facility in Plymouth and is facing deportation to Afghanistan, despite holding a Special Immigrant Visa.

AFGHAN AGONY

He risked his life as an interpreter for US soldiers; now he faces deportation

By Hanna Krueger
GLOBE STAFF

In 2006, as the Taliban unleashed their fiercest offensive since the war's start, a teenage Afghan walked into a US military base and volunteered to help the Americans.

Zia became an interpreter, spending four years translating conversations, relaying intelligence, and assessing volatile situations.

The pay was modest but the price was steep: threatening notes appeared outside the family compound; an explosive thrown into their courtyard sent shrapnel into his nephew's eye. In the late 2000s, the Taliban kidnapped and tortured Zia's older brother for months.

When Zia's country fell again to Taliban rule, he looked for reprieve to a special visa program created for people like him: Afghan nationals who worked on behalf of the US government. Last year, he finally received approval and set off for America with his wife and children.

The family of seven moved into a yellow saltbox in Connecticut with a white picket fence and a billowing American flag. Free of the threat of the Taliban, they appeared poised for permanence — with a green card for Zia on the horizon.

ZIA, Page A7



WAKIL KOHSAR/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Taliban security personnel stood guard as Afghan refugees arrived at the border after being deported from Iran in June.

BUBBLING OVER WITH JOY

Miranda Wang of China was doused with champagne by Zhang Weiwei (right) and Rose Zhang (left) on the 18th green after winning the LPGA FM Championship golf tournament Sunday at TPC Boston in Norton. The Chinese rookie captured her first LPGA title after edging Thailand's top-ranked Jeeno Thitikul by one stroke. **C1.**



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Opposition to any National Guard deployment in Boston is unifying the city's more progressive and conservative officials. President Trump continues to promote the idea to fight big city crime. **B1.**

There is no end in sight to the garbage strike bedeviling Greater Boston, as the Teamsters' action against Republic Services reaches the two-month mark. **D1.**

The Israeli military said that it killed Abu Obeida, the long-time spokesperson for Hamas's armed wing, in an attack on Gaza City. **A4.**

Even with piles of evidence to scrutinize, investigators say they may never know the motive in the shooting that left two children dead in a Minneapolis church last week. **A2.**



Rays on end

Monday: Sunny and pleasant. High 72-77, low 58-63.

Tuesday: Another fine day. High 71-76, low 57-62.

Sunrise: 6:09. Sunset: 7:18.

Obituaries, **C8.**

Comics and Weather, **D4-5.**

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